

Something in the Way She Moves

2 languages

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Not to be confused with [Something in the Way You Move](#) or [Something \(Beatles song\)](#).

"**Something in the Way She Moves**" is a song written by [James Taylor](#) that appeared on his [1968 eponymous debut album](#) for [Apple Records](#). The first version released was in April 1968 by [Tom Rush](#) on his album *The Circle Game*, before Taylor's later that year. The song has also been covered by other artists, including [Bobbie Gentry](#) and [Harry Belafonte](#). The opening line inspired [George Harrison](#) to write the No. 1 [Beatles'](#) song "[Something](#)". According to James Taylor's stage banter at The Star in Frisco on 31 July 2017, this was the song he played for [Paul McCartney](#) and George Harrison as an audition before signing with Apple Records.

"Something in the Way She Moves"

Song by [James Taylor](#)

from the album *[James Taylor](#)*

Released	December 6, 1968 ^[1]
Recorded	Trident , London ^[2]
Genre	Folk rock
Length	2:54
Label	Apple Records
Songwriter	James Taylor
Producer	Peter Asher

James Taylor version [\[edit \]](#)

"Something in the Way She Moves" is a romantic song.^[3] *Rolling Stone* critic [Jon Landau](#) regards the song as being about "transcendence of a sort."^[4] Taylor plays the song accompanied only by acoustic guitar.^[4]

AllMusic critic Lindsay Planer regards "Something in the Way She Moves" as one of the "notable inclusions" on the *James Taylor* album.^[5] Fellow *AllMusic* critic David R. Adler described it as "one of Taylor's finest melodies".^[6] *Rolling Stone Album Guide* critic Mark Coleman agrees that it is a "highlight" of *James Taylor*, describing the song as "winsome" and predicting the path Taylor would take in future recordings.^[7] Taylor biographer Timothy White describes it as being "unquestionably Taylor's finest performance" on *James Taylor*.^[2] White described it as "spare in presentation" and "poignant on its own elegant terms."^[2] *Rolling Stone* critic [Jon Landau](#) believes that the spare performance and Taylor's "restrained delivery" add to the song's power, as Taylor "lets the melody, lyric, guitar, and voice speak for themselves."^[4] Martin Charles Strong describes it as being a "memorable original" and one that "marked Taylor out as a kind of male [Joni Mitchell](#), if not quite as adventurous."^[8]

Taylor included "Something in the Way She Moves" on his 1976 *Greatest Hits* but, as with "[Carolina in My Mind](#)", also from *James Taylor*, he had to re-record the song due to rights issues.^[9] It was also included on the 2003 *compilation album* *The Best of James Taylor*^[10] (although original pressings of that album

contained a shortened version without harpsichord of the original Apple Records version). A live version was included on Taylor's and [Carole King](#)'s live album *Live at the Troubadour*.^[11] A solo live version leads off Taylor's album *One Man Band*.^[12]

Inspiration for "Something" [edit]

[George Harrison](#) liked "Something in the Way She Moves" so much that he used the beginning as the first line of his 1969 song "[Something](#)" from [the Beatles](#) album *Abbey Road*, which was released as a single and reached No. 1.^{[13][14]} Early in the development of "Something", Harrison had expanded the opening of this song to "Something in the way she moves / Attracts me like a [pomegranate](#)," using the word "pomegranate" simply as a place-holder until better words could be found.^{[14][15][16]}

Taylor has stated that "I never thought for a second that George intended to do that. I don't think he intentionally ripped anything off, and all music is borrowed from other music. So completely I let it pass."^[13] Taylor also acknowledged that the ending of "Something in the Way She Moves" was taken from the Beatles' song "[I Feel Fine](#)" and so "what goes around comes around."^[13]

Tom Rush version [edit]

[Tom Rush](#) recorded "Something in the Way She Moves" on his 1968 album *The Circle Game*.^[3] Taylor had played the song for Rush when he visited the [Elektra Records](#) offices for an audition in 1967.^[2] Rush's version was released first, before Taylor's later in 1968. It was released as a single and become popular on New England radio stations.^{[13][2]} *Crawdaddy!* reviewed the song as being the best song on *The Circle Game*, saying that it "flows beautifully with [Bruce Langhorne](#)'s [country](#) stylings pushing it through," also acknowledging that "Rush's brand of vocalizing fits perfectly" because "he can never get excited about anything."^[13]

Other versions [edit]

Country artist [Bobbie Gentry](#) recorded a version titled "Something in the Way He Moves" for her 1970 album *Fancy*.

[Iain Matthews](#) and his band [Matthews' Southern Comfort](#) recorded a version of "Something in the Way She Moves" for his 1970 album *Second Spring*.

[Harry Belafonte](#) covered the song as the opening track of his 1971 album *The Warm Touch*.^[17] He also released it as a single. *Billboard* regarded "Something in the Way

"Something in the Way She Moves"



Single by [Tom Rush](#)

from the album *[The Circle Game](#)*

B-side	"Rockport Sunday"
Released	1968
Genre	Folk rock
Length	3:25
Label	Elektra
Songwriter	James Taylor
Producer	Arthur Gorson

She Moves" as one of the "standout" tracks on *The Warm Touch*.^[18] *Billboard* also called the melody "beautiful" and stated that Belafonte gave the song "his own unique treatment."^[19]

Mitchel Forman recorded an acoustic piano version of "Something in the Way She Moves" for the 2001 multi-artist album *Sketches of James: Selection from the James Taylor Songbook*.^[6]

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 V • T • E	 James Taylor [hide]
 Studio albums	<i>James Taylor</i> · <i>Sweet Baby James</i> · <i>Mud Slide Slim and the Blue Horizon</i> · <i>One Man Dog</i> · <i>Walking Man</i> · <i>Gorilla</i> · <i>In the Pocket</i> · <i>JT</i> · <i>Flag</i> · <i>Dad Loves His Work</i> · <i>That's Why I'm Here</i> · <i>Never Die Young</i> · <i>New Moon Shine</i> · <i>Hourglass</i> · <i>October Road</i> · <i>Covers</i> · <i>Before This World</i> · <i>American Standard</i>
 Live albums	<i>Live/Best Live</i> · <i>One Man Band</i> · <i>Amchitka</i> · <i>Live at the Troubadour</i> · <i>Live at the Beacon Theatre (DVD video)</i>

Holiday albums	<i>A Christmas Album</i> · <i>James Taylor at Christmas</i>
Compilation albums	<i>Greatest Hits</i> · <i>Classic Songs</i> · <i>Greatest Hits Volume 2</i> · <i>The Best of James Taylor</i> · <i>The Essential James Taylor</i>
Extended plays	<i>Other Covers</i>
Singles	"Carolina in My Mind" · "Knocking 'Round the Zoo" · "Sweet Baby James" · "Fire and Rain" · "Country Road" · "You've Got a Friend" · "Long Ago and Far Away" · "Don't Let Me Be Lonely Tonight" · "One Man Parade" · "Hymn" · "Mockingbird" (with Carly Simon) · "How Sweet It Is (to Be Loved by You)" · "Mexico" · "Shower the People" · "Woman's Gotta Have It" · "Handy Man" · "Your Smiling Face" · "Honey Don't Leave L.A." · "Devoted to You" (with Carly Simon) · "Up on the Roof" · "Her Town Too" · "Hard Times" · "Everyday" · "Only One" · "Copperline" · "It's Growing" · "Change"
Other songs	"Night Owl" · " Something in the Way She Moves " · "Sunny Skies" · "Steamroller Blues" · "You Can Close Your Eyes" · "Highway Song" · "I Was a Fool to Care" · "Bartender's Blues" · "Secret O' Life" · "Millworker" · "Summer's Here"
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